Adventure for the Fifth Edition (2024) · Warcraft Setting

THE FALL OF QUEL'THALAS

and the Fate of Sylvanas Windrunner



For four or five characters of levels 3 to 5

By Jorge Gómez Vaello

Fan content · Non-profit

Contents

Introduction **3**

Premise and Tragic Principle 3

Plots and Table Tools 3

Place Names: Period Name and Future Name 3

Dramatis Personae **4**

Places **6**

Episode 1: The Chapel of the Dawn **7**

Episode 2: The Pass **8**

Episode 3: The Spire and the Elrendar **9**

Episode 4: The Runestones **10**

The Players' Ideas 10

Pursuit: Ul'gruk's Flight 11

The Magisters' Delegation 12

The Suspects (to Open Ep. 5) 12

Episode 5: The Sanctum of the Moon **13**

Investigation Mechanics 13

Episode 6: The Gates of Silvermoon **15**

Convoy Mechanics 15

The Letter for Vereesa (Optional, a Player Handout) 15

Epilogue **17**

Appendix A: Stat Blocks **18**

High-Level Characters 18

The Rangers of Silvermoon 22

Traitors and Enemies 25

Other Characters 29

Appendix B: Magic Items **31**

Appendix C: To Be Adjusted to the Sourcebook **33**

Credits

Design and text: Jorge Gómez Vaello. **Illustrations:** provided by the author, AI-generated; no official art, logos or emblems of Blizzard or Wizards. **Layout, hover cards and English translation:** with the assistance of Claude.

Status: preliminary version, written before the publication of the setting's official sourcebook. Challenge ratings, difficulty classes and statistics are provisional (see Appendix C).

License: the text, original mechanics, illustrations, original characters and hover-card texts of this adventure (written by the author; each card links to the corresponding Wowpedia article for reference) are dedicated to the public domain under CC0 1.0. The dedication does not extend to material from the SRD 5.2, which keeps its CC-BY-4.0 license, nor to the trademarks, names, characters and places of Warcraft, which do not belong to the author.

SRD 5.2: This work includes material from the System Reference Document 5.2 ("SRD 5.2") by Wizards of the Coast LLC, available at https://www.dndbeyond.com/srd. The SRD 5.2 is licensed under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License, available at https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/legalcode.

Wizards Fan Content Policy: The Fall of Quel'Thalas is unofficial Fan Content permitted under the Fan Content Policy. Not approved/endorsed by Wizards. Portions of the materials used are property of Wizards of the Coast. ©Wizards of the Coast LLC.

Legal notice: unofficial, free, non-profit fan content. It is not approved, sponsored or endorsed by Blizzard Entertainment or by Wizards of the Coast. Warcraft and the names of its characters and places belong to Blizzard Entertainment, Inc. Dungeons & Dragons is a trademark of Wizards of the Coast LLC.

Introduction

> *"My mother used to say that a ranger doesn't die in the forest: she stays in it."*
> — Sylvanas Windrunner

Premise and Tragic Principle

A D&D adventure set in *Warcraft* for 4–5 characters of the *Alliance*, levels 3 to 5, in about six episodes. It is an epic that turns out to be a tragedy: the characters achieve great deeds alongside *Sylvanas Windrunner* and, without knowing it, contribute to her undoing and to the fall of *Quel'Thalas* before *the Scourge* and *Arthas*.

The tragedy works through irony, not surprise. Like the Athenian audience watching Oedipus, many players who know the story will know that *Sylvanas* dies. The unexpected is not what happens, but how, and who brings it about.

- **Hamartia.** The characters' error is their own excellence: every victory beside *Sylvanas* enrages *Arthas* further.
- **Peripeteia.** Unmasking the traitor (Ep. 5) leads *Sylvanas* to stay and defend the last pass instead of withdrawing.
- **Anagnorisis.** In Ep. 6 they understand that everything they did right led to that moment.
- **Catharsis.** The choice between the bad and the fatal, and the epilogue.

One final mission. The refugees are the message. Among them travels a single witness, *Dar'Khan*'s young apprentice, who knows that *Arthas* seeks the *Sunwell* to raise *Kel'Thuzad* and will then go after *Dalaran*. The convoy also carries *Sylvanas*'s letter for *Vereesa*. Saving the convoy means saving the truth; the characters become the "angelos", the messenger who survives to tell. Final irony: the message arrives, but *Dalaran* falls all the same.

Plots and Table Tools

The lore plot (background for the players). The march of *Arthas* from *Lordaeron* to the *Sunwell* to raise *Kel'Thuzad*. The players watch it advance through messengers, refugees, smoke on the horizon and distant echoes.

The investigation plot (foreground). The traitor is ***Dar'Khan Drathir***, a *quel'dorei* magister who in canon helped *Arthas* overcome the kingdom's magical defenses. Clues: the *Scourge* knows hidden paths, the runestones fail, a magister's seal turns up. The deep investigation (interrogations, suspects) is saved for episodes 4 and 5.

The Horde thread. The vanguard is hunting ***Ul'gruk Ashtongue***, an orc warlock who survived the *Shadow Council* and serves *the Scourge* out of faith: he has recognized in the *Lich King* his old master, *Ner'zhul*.

The *Scourge* Clock. A visible tracker of the canonical milestones. It advances even if the players triumph.

1. Fall of *Lordaeron*; death of *Uther*; the urn of *Terenas* sets out north (Ep. 1).
2. *The Scourge* reaches the border; *Sylvanas* warns *Arthas* off (Ep. 2).
3. The bridges of the *Elrendar* (Ep. 3).
4. The runestones and the Elfgates (Ep. 4).
5. Siege of *Silvermoon* (Ep. 5).
6. Fall of *Silvermoon*; death of *Sylvanas*; the *Sunwell* (Ep. 6 and epilogue).

Bond with *Sylvanas*. A discreet record of shared scenes, rangers known by name and objects (the Windrunner arrow). No mechanics: it is memory that returns in Ep. 6.

Place Names: Period Name and Future Name

During the adventure only the period names are used. The future names are spoken for the first time in the epilogue, so that the geography itself tells of the defeat.

During the adventure	What it will become (epilogue)
Eastern *Lordaeron*	*Eastern Plaguelands*
Chapel of the Dawn (invented name)	*Light's Hope Chapel*
Southern *Eversong Woods*	*Ghostlands*
The Scourge's road to *Silvermoon*	*The Dead Scar*
The inner wall of *Silvermoon*	The Ruins of Silvermoon

Dramatis Personae

> *"Don't thank me. Give me time; it's the only thing worth anything right now."*
> — Sylvanas Windrunner

Each entry includes a description to read aloud the first time the character appears, and notes for the GM. The names of the minor rangers are invented.

Sylvanas Windrunner, Ranger-General of Silvermoon

First appearance: Ep. 2, after the ambush.

> She drops from the tree without a sound, as if the air had left her there. She is tall even for an elf, and moves like someone who never wastes a gesture. Her hair, the color of wheat at sunset, is tied back; the green ranger's hood is pushed back, as if she did not care whether she was seen. Her eyes shine with the faint blue of the Sunwell, and she looks at you unhurriedly, weighing what you are worth. She carries a longbow of white wood, carved with the eagle of her house. An arrow is still on the string. She has not lowered it.

Notes. Proud, ironic, loyal to her own to the last. She knows every ranger by name. Her pride is her virtue and her "hamartia". Family: her mother *Lireesa* (Ranger-General before her, killed in battle), *Alleria* (older sister, lost beyond the *Dark Portal*), *Vereesa* (the youngest, in *Dalaran*) and *Lirath* (younger brother, killed by the *Amani*). Check family details against the novel *Sylvanas* by *Christie Golden*.

Lor'themar Theron, ranger lieutenant

First appearance: Ep. 2, at the camp.

> If Sylvanas is an arrow, the elf who walks in her shadow is the bow that holds it. Tall, broad-shouldered for his race, with long blond hair tied at the nape. The first thing you see is the patch: a piece of dark leather over his left eye, crossed by a pale scar that runs down to his cheek. His remaining eye does not blink. He wears a sword at his side and a bow on his back, both worn from long use. He does not greet you. He watches you like someone counting how many of you will survive the winter, and the numbers don't add up.

Notes. Loyal, sober, of few words; his rare smile is an event in the camp. He survives the fall and guides the convoy in Ep. 6. In canon he will become regent of *Quel'Thalas*, which the epilogue may hint at. Check in the sourcebook when he lost the eye; if later, replace the patch with a fresh scar.

Halduron Brightwing, ranger

> He is the only elf in the camp who smiles at you without reservation. Angular face, restless eyes, a hawk feather pinned in his braid. He talks with his hands and jokes with everyone, even with Lor'themar, who never laughs.

Notes. The warm counterpoint of the command group. He may be the first elf to trust the characters.

Taeren, the youngest ranger

> He is barely more than a boy: his face still unformed, his bow too big for him, his arrowheads sharpened again and again by the fire. When Sylvanas walks past him he stands so straight he looks about to snap.

Notes. He should appear in every episode from Ep. 2 on. *Sylvanas* protects him because he reminds her of *Lirath*. His fate in Ep. 6 (to obey and leave with the convoy, or disobey and stay) will weigh almost as much as hers.

Other rangers

- ***Velendris***, a grey-haired veteran ranger, the best archer after *Sylvanas*.
- ***Saelis***, who always comes back wounded and never bandages himself in time.
- ***Aelyra***, in charge of the watches and the fords.

Vereesa Windrunner

Not on stage; only in the Dalaran interlude (Ep. 6).

> She is the youngest of the Windrunner sisters, and it shows in everything: in the liveliness of her gestures, in the silver hair that escapes any braid, in blue eyes that still expect good news from the world. She lives in Dalaran, among mages, far from the forest, but she keeps on her wall the ranger's bow her mother gave her, as one keeps a promise.

Notes. Recipient of *Sylvanas*'s letter. She is the one left alone: mother dead, *Alleria* lost, *Sylvanas* fallen.

Ilthanar, the witness

> A young elf with slender, ink-stained hands, wearing the scarlet tunic of a magister's apprentice, torn and caked with mud. He trembles constantly. When he speaks, he whispers, glancing over his shoulder, as if his master could hear him from any shadow.

Notes. *Dar'Khan*'s apprentice. He knows what *Arthas* wants the *Sunwell* for, and that his next target is *Dalaran*. He carries his master's seal as proof. He appears in Ep. 5.

Dar'Khan Drathir, magister

> He is the kind of elf who makes a room feel colder when he enters. Tall, thin, with silver-grey hair cut with precision; his fingers heavy with rings that hum faintly with magic. He dresses in scarlet and gold, the colors of the magisters of Silvermoon, without a single crease. His voice is soft and patient, that of a teacher correcting a mistake. Only his eyes give something away: a sickly green at the bottom of the blue, like a pond beginning to rot.

Notes. He despises the royal family and the rangers. He has sold the kingdom's defenses to *Arthas*. In Ep. 5 he is unmasked, but escapes: canon needs him alive.

Ul'gruk Ashtongue, orc warlock

> An old orc, hunched beneath a cloak made of tattered banners. His skin is not green but grey, like something that has been too close to the fire. His lower tusks are missing; in their place he wears two needles of blackened bone. When he speaks, a thin smoke that smells of sulfur escapes his mouth, and his tongue, when it shows, is black as coal.

Notes. A survivor of the *Shadow Council*, escaped from the internment camps. He serves the *Lich King* because he has recognized *Ner'zhul* in him. *Sylvanas* wounds him in Ep. 2. His final fate is left open.

Arthas Menethil, prince of Lordaeron

Seen only from afar, except in the final scene.

> He rides a horse that is no longer a horse: bones and armor, with blue fire in its sockets. He himself seems made of winter. His hair, white as cold ash, falls over rune-etched plate armor. In his hand he holds a longsword that breathes frost, and the grass withers where he passes. The most terrible thing is not his appearance but his calm: he is in no hurry, because he knows nothing you do will stop him.



Places

> *"One day they will give it a name."*
> — Eversong Woods, Episode 6

Descriptions to read on arriving at each place. They are listed in order of appearance.

The roads of eastern Lordaeron (Ep. 1)

The fields should be green at this time of year. But the wheat bends grey, as if someone had stolen its color. Along the road pass empty carts, open doors that no one has closed, a dog sitting in silence in front of a farmhouse, waiting. In the distance, to the north, the sky bears a brown stain that is no cloud. The crows always fly in the same direction. That way.

The Chapel of the Dawn (Ep. 1)

The chapel stands on a rise of pale stone, with a low tower and a bell that no one has stopped ringing. Around it, a makeshift camp: tents made of blankets, campfires, wounded laid on straw. Hundreds of faces turn toward you as you arrive, looking for someone you are not. Inside it smells of wax and blood. Above the altar, someone has written in charcoal a list of names from Stratholme. It does not fit on the wall.

The Thalassian Pass (Ep. 2)

The road climbs between ever-narrower mountains, and with every bend the air changes. Behind you lie the dirty snow and the dead trees. Ahead, the first golden pines of Quel'Thalas, tall as towers, with needles that shine as if they held light inside. In the snow, between the trunks, there are bare footprints. Many. All heading the same way.

The ranger camp (Ep. 2)

You don't see it until you are inside. Moss-colored canvas stretched between the trees, smokeless fires, bows hanging from the branches like fruit. No one speaks loudly. The rangers move among the shadows with the ease of those born in them, and they watch you pass in silence: humans, in their forest.

Windrunner Spire (Ep. 3)

The tower rises over the coast like an arrow driven into the sky. White stone, blue roofs, banners with the Windrunner eagle snapping in the sea wind. A home, not a fortress: neglected gardens, a dry fountain, and a rope swing hanging from an oak in the courtyard, worn by hands that no longer use it.

The Elrendar River and its bridges (Ep. 3)

The Elrendar flows down from the heart of the forest, deep and green as old glass. It is crossed by bridges that do not look made by hands: arches of white stone, slender as ribs, with railings carved like leaves and lamps that light themselves at nightfall. They have stood here for centuries. Tonight you will have to bring them down.

The runestones (Ep. 4)

In a clearing stands a monolith of dark stone, three times taller than a man, covered in runes that pulse with a reddish-golden glow. The air around it hums, and the hair on your arms stands on end. It is one of the stones that uphold the invisible barrier protecting the heart of the kingdom. While it shines, the dead cannot pass. Some runes, on one side, have begun to fade.

The Sanctum of the Moon (Ep. 5)

White columns in a circle, roofless, open to the sky. In the center, a basin of water in which the moons are reflected even by day. The priestesses call it a place of calm. Today no one is here. The offering flowers have dried up, and someone has left on the stone a trail of wax of exactly the color of the magisters' seals.

Eversong Woods and the Gates of Silvermoon (Ep. 6)

They called this forest Eversong because it was never silent: the wind in the golden leaves, the birds, the fountains. Now it is silent. Before you rises the wall of Silvermoon, white and gold, its gates shut and its towers lit. Behind, the forest burns. Between the two, a strip of land where the grass blackens as the column of the Scourge advances, as if the world were drawing a wound upon itself. One day they will give it a name.

Episode 1: The Chapel of the Dawn

> *"If the prince goes north, the Ranger-General will be waiting for him."*
> — A quel'dorei ranger, at the Chapel of the Dawn

The vanguard follows *Ul'gruk*'s trail, defends a refugee chapel and discovers that the warlock and the Cult are heading for *Quel'Thalas*.

Lore moment. *Lordaeron* has fallen. *Uther* has died defending the urn of *Terenas*, which *Arthas* now uses to carry the remains of *Kel'Thuzad* north. The characters only hear it as rumor.

1. **Opening on the road.** Refugees from *Stratholme*, empty villages, crows flying north. A mood scene (read "The roads of eastern *Lordaeron*").
2. **Minor encounter: the crossroads.** A *Scourge* patrol and a felhound left behind by *Ul'gruk* attack a refugee family. The demon proves the warlock passed this way.
3. **The chapel.** Roleplay with a wounded paladin who served with *Uther*, a child who asks about *Stratholme* and a quel'dorei ranger coming from the north. He is the first to speak the name: *"If the prince goes north, the Ranger-General will be waiting for him."*
4. **Main encounter: the night at the chapel.** An assault in waves led by an acolyte of the *Cult of the Damned*: ghouls, skeletons and a lesser abomination. The characters must choose what to defend (sanctuary, infirmary or gate).

Clues. A map of *Quel'Thalas* with the runestones marked; a fragment of a magister's seal (*Dar'Khan*, not yet identified); notes in Orcish about "the King of Cold" and "the elves' fountain"; the account of someone who saw the royal urn pass northward.

Wrap-up. By dawn, *Ul'gruk* has already crossed toward the *Thalassian Pass*.

Provisional numbers (5e). Ghouls and skeletons CR 1/4–1; acolyte CR 2; lesser abomination CR 3–4. Adjust to the source-book.



Episode 2: The Pass

> *"The general doesn't let humans into her camp. Ever."*
> — Halduron Brightwing

Ul'gruk springs an impossible ambush in the *Thalassian Pass* and *Sylvanas* saves the group; a pragmatic alliance begins.

Lore moment. *The Scourge* reaches the border. In canon, *Sylvanas* warns *Arthas* to turn back and he ignores her. **Background tension:** *Quel'Thalas* left the Alliance after the Second War; the characters are not welcome.

1. **The climb** (read "The *Thalassian Pass*"). An abandoned ranger post, dead sentries with no signs of a struggle: someone knew when the guard changed.
2. **Minor encounter: the trail guardian.** A lesser demon and the fallen sentries raised as zombies.
3. **The ambush.** Cultists, ghouls and a gargoyle in a gorge, with *Ul'gruk* commanding from above. Designed so that they cannot win it.
4. **The intervention of *Sylvanas*.** Arrows from the trees, an elven horn, the undead swept away. *Sylvanas* wounds *Ul'gruk*, who flees. Read her description in *Dramatis Personae*.
5. **The first conversation.** She doesn't thank them; she reminds them that *Lordaeron* could not defend itself. She listens, and when she sees the map of the runestones her expression changes.
6. **The camp** (read "The ranger camp", the description of *Lor'themar* and the following text).

Text: the ranger camp

Sylvanas does not stop, but she does not stop talking either. She greets each of them like someone calling the roll of what she loves most.

—Velendris, that arrow in the big ghoul's neck was yours. Don't think I didn't see it. —A grey-haired ranger bows her head—. Saelis, bandage that arm before I make it an order. Aelyra, double watch at the ford tonight.

By the fire, a boy who barely looks like a man sharpens arrowheads with too much zeal. Sylvanas stops beside him.

—Taeren. You didn't fall back today.

—No, general.

—You won't tomorrow either. But tonight, sleep.

And she walks on, without looking back. The boy stands frozen, as if he had been handed a silver sword. Beside you, Halduron murmurs: "The general doesn't let humans into her camp. Ever."

Wrap-up and level 4. *Sylvanas* offers a deal: the information in exchange for sword arms. She takes them south, toward the *Elrendar*.



Episode 3: The Spire and the Elrendar

> *"Every bridge that falls is one more day for Silvermoon."*
> — Sylvanas Windrunner

Sylvanas opens her home to the characters and, together, they bring down the bridges of the *Elrendar* before the eyes of *Arthas*. It is the first great bonding episode.

Lore moment. *The Scourge* crosses the border. *Sylvanas* falls back and destroys every crossing behind her: each fallen bridge is a day for *Silvermoon*. Third milestone of the Clock.

Structure

1. **Arrival at *Windrunner Spire*.** Read "*Windrunner Spire*" and the text about the swing.
2. **Minor encounter: the *Amani*.** Troll scouts prowl near the Spire. After the fight, a wounded troll is left on the ground. *Sylvanas* finishes him off, or lets him live with icy contempt: the GM chooses which face of her to show. Either way, it is a crack that connects to *Lirath*.
3. **The confidence.** At night, in the upper hall: the portraits (text below).
4. **Council of war.** *Sylvanas* spreads out a map of the *Elrendar* and **asks their opinion**: which bridge to defend to the end, where to set ambushes, how much to risk. The players' ideas must become part of the plan. It is the seed of the *hamartia*: from here on, *Sylvanas*'s strategy is also theirs.
5. **Main encounter: the last bridge.** The rangers have carved collapse runes into the piers; they must be kept active for several rounds while ghouls, a crypt fiend and acolytes of *Ul'gruk* charge. Half combat, half skill challenge (Arcana to complete the runes, Athletics to pull back the wounded). In the middle of the chaos, ***Taeren* is trapped** on the wrong side of the bridge: the characters can rescue him.
6. **The fall of the bridge.** Read the final text. *Arthas* appears on the far bank for the first time.

Light clue. One of the collapse runes has been altered with a stroke no ranger knows how to make: magister magic. *Sylvanas* sees it and says nothing.

Wrap-up. *Arthas* will have to make a detour of several days. The first true victory. The characters stay at level 4.

Text: the swing

Sylvanas keeps her eyes on the swing.

—My father hung it for Vereesa. She was the little one. Alleria and I were too old for swings, or so we said. —She shrugs—. Then we fought over it when no one was looking.

Text: the portraits

In the upper hall there is a portrait: a woman in ranger armor, a hawk's gaze, her bow slung across her back.

—Lireesa Windrunner. Ranger-General before me. —Sylvanas speaks without turning—. She died defending this kingdom. No one expected otherwise. Nor did she.

Beside the portrait, a smaller one: a boy with a crooked smile.

—Lirath. My brother. The Amani killed him when he was younger than Taeren. —A long pause—. That's why I don't let the boy ride in the vanguard. Don't tell him.

There is a third frame on the wall. It is empty. She says nothing, and none of you dares to ask.

The empty frame is Alleria; it is not explained until Ep. 5.

Text: the fall of the bridge

The runes all ignite at once. For an instant, the whole bridge shines as it did on the day it was built. Then it breaks. The white arches buckle like broken ribs and fall into the river with a roar that shakes the trees, dragging with them the dead who were still crossing.

When the water calms, you see him. On the far bank, still on a horse of bones, a white-haired rider looks over the wreckage. He does not shout. He gives no orders. He only looks across the river, toward Sylvanas.

She raises her bow, slowly, and salutes him with it.

The rider turns away. Beside you, Lor'themar says quietly: "She shouldn't have done that." Sylvanas smiles. It is the first time you have seen her truly smile.

Episode 4: The Runestones

> *"Tell your master that Quel'Thalas has nothing for him."*
> — Sylvanas Windrunner

The defense of a runestone is *Sylvanas*'s great tactical victory, and the players design it with her. At the same time, *Arthas* condemns her for it, and the traitor enters the scene without anyone recognizing him.

Lore moment. *The Scourge* reaches the line of runestones that upholds the barrier around the heart of the kingdom. Fourth milestone of the Clock. Every victory of *Sylvanas*'s here is real, and it is also what *Arthas* will never forgive her.

Structure

1. **Arrival at the stone** (read "The runestones" in *Places*). Some runes are already fading.
2. **Council of war.** *Sylvanas* asks for ideas. Each proposal adopted grants a concrete advantage in the defense (table below).
3. **The herald of *Arthas*.** Before the assault, a fallen knight brings the prince's message (text below).
4. **Main encounter: the defense.** Three waves. In the third, *Ul'gruk* sabotages the stone and flees: the pursuit begins while *Sylvanas* holds out.
5. **The pursuit** (see below).
6. **The magisters' delegation.** At dawn, magisters from *Silvermoon* arrive to "reinforce" the runes. Among them is *Dar'Khan*, helpful and kind. No one suspects him yet.
7. **The night of victory.** Celebration, the Windrunner arrow and level 5.

The texts of the herald and the night follow; the pursuit and the delegation come after.

The Players' Ideas

If the players propose something of their own and reasonable, accept it with an equivalent effect. What matters is that they see their plan in action.

Proposal	Effect on the defense
Oil-and-fire trenches on the road	Wave 1 arrives weakened and in disorder
Archers hidden in the trees	Advantage in the first round of each wave
A false retreat to lure the dead into a ravine	Wave 2 is split into two groups
Shield the rune-bearers	The stone loses one rune fewer in wave 3

Stone integrity. The stone has 6 runes. Each enemy that reaches it and spends a round beside it puts one out. If they all go out, the barrier falls, but *Sylvanas* manages to hold back the *Scourge* all the same: the victory stands; only its cost in dead rangers changes.

Text: the herald of Arthas

Up the road comes a lone rider, at a walk, carrying a tattered banner of Lordaeron. He wears the armor of a paladin of the Silver Hand, but the emblem on his chest is covered in black frost. As he draws near, you recognize him. It is the wounded paladin from the Chapel of the Dawn, the one who served with Uther. His eyes now burn with a blue fire.

—Ranger-General —he says, in a voice that is not entirely his own—. My lord admires your stubbornness. Surrender the stone, and he will grant you a quick death. Keep resisting, and he will grant you something far worse.

Sylvanas draws her bow without haste.

—Tell your master that Quel'Thalas has nothing for him. No stones, no bridges, no quick deaths. —She looses. The arrow strikes the banner, a hand's breadth from the herald's head—. And tell him the next one won't miss.

The fallen knight turns away. Before he leaves, he looks at you. For an instant, something in his face seems to remember the chapel.

If the paladin died in Ep. 1, the effect is harsher still. If he survived and stayed at the chapel, the players will understand that the chapel has fallen too.

Text: the night of victory

For the first time in weeks, the camp sings. Someone has found Silvermoon wine. Halduron imitates a ghoul tripping over its own leg, and even Lor'themar smiles, which, according to the rangers, hasn't happened in a century.

Sylvanas sits down by your fire. She doesn't ask if she may.

—I owe you an apology. I said the Alliance always arrives late. —She drinks—. You arrived in time. It's an exception; don't get used to it.

She draws an arrow from her quiver. The shaft is white and the fletching bears the Windrunner blue.

—My mother gave me one like this when I won my first battle. She said it wasn't for shooting, but for remembering. —She holds it out to you—. Remember this day. We have stopped the prince of Lordaeron. Let others tell it to you; I already know.

Pursuit: Ul'gruk's Flight

During the assault on the runestone, *Ul'gruk* tries to put out its runes and flees toward the *Sanctum of the Moon*. The pursuit lasts five scenes. **Whether they catch him or not does not matter to the plot**: either way, the characters obtain the clue that leads to Ep. 5.

Mechanics (provisional DCs for level 4; adjust to the sourcebook)

- **Distance.** *Ul'gruk* starts at **Distance 3**, because he sets off first and knows the way.
- **Rolls per scene.** Each pursuer chooses one of the two checks the scene offers.
    - Success: keeps pace.
    - Success by 5 or more: gains ground.
    - Failure: takes 1 **Lag**. With **2 Lags** they lose the trail and drop out of the pursuit; they reappear at the end, late and out of breath.
- **Group progress.** If half or more of the active pursuers succeed, the Distance drops by 1. If, in addition, anyone gains ground, it drops by 1 more (maximum 2 per scene).
- **Help.** A spell or a clever idea grants advantage to oneself or to a companion, at the cost of spending the resource.
- **Advantage of *Ul'gruk*: the Ash Talisman.** Once per pursuit, the GM can cancel one pursuer's success (a gust of ash blinds them at the worst moment). It is not infallible, but it tips the balance.

- **Guaranteed escape.** If at the end of scene 5 the Distance is greater than 0, *Ul'gruk* summons a **felsteed** and escapes. If it reaches 0 sooner, they catch him and there is a fight.

Taeren asks to join the pursuit. If they accept, he rolls too, and if he accumulates 2 Lags he is in danger: someone must go back for him, at the cost of 1 Lag for whoever does.

Scene	Place	Checks	Ul'gruk's complication
1	Golden undergrowth	Survival (tracking) or Acrobatics (dodging branches)	He sets fel flames in the brush: Dexterity save or fire damage
2	The swollen stream	Athletics (wading) or Acrobatics (leaping from rock to rock)	The current: whoever fails, besides the Lag, loses an item that is not secured
3	The ash fog	Perception (seeing through) or Wisdom save (resisting fear)	Ul'gruk spits his black smoke: whispers of the dead in the fog
4	Ruins with Amani	Stealth (passing unseen), Deception (distracting them) or a brief fight	Ul'gruk pays the trolls to block the way
5	The crag above the Sanctum	Athletics (climbing) or Investigation (shortcut)	If the Distance is greater than 0, the felsteed appears

Outcomes

- **They catch him.** A brief fight. As he falls, *Ul'gruk* laughs: *"The King of Cold already has my soul. You only have my body."* In his pouch they find a letter sealed with the magister's seal and a meeting at the *Sanctum of the Moon*.
- **He escapes.** In the flight, the felsteed tears the pouch from his saddle. It contains the same letter. *Ul'gruk* is free to reappear in Ep. 6 beside *Arthas*.

Text: the start of the pursuit

A green blast shakes the clearing. The stone's runes flicker and, for an instant, go out. At the edge of the forest, a hunched figure limps away with a speed impossible for such an old orc, leaving a trail of black smoke among the golden trunks.

—Ul'gruk! —shouts Sylvanas, never ceasing to shoot at the dead climbing the slope—. I can't leave the stone! You go!

The Magisters' Delegation

At dawn, after the pursuit, a small delegation arrives from *Silvermoon* to repair the runes. It is the first time the players see *Dar'Khan* (read his description in *Dramatis Personae*). He should seem the most helpful of them all, not the most suspicious.

> They arrive in palanquins of scarlet silk, with escorts in golden armor that has not been splashed with mud the whole way. The rangers watch them pass in silence, filthy with blood and ash. One of the magisters stops before the runestone, runs his fingers over the dead runes and clicks his tongue.
>
> —Hasty work. Understandable, given the circumstances. —He looks at you and smiles with perfect courtesy—. Don't worry. It is in good hands now.
>
> The runes light up under his fingers, one after another. They shine brighter than before. Sylvanas watches with her arms crossed and says nothing.

What no one knows. *Dar'Khan* does not repair the runes: he binds them to his own will, so that he can put them out when *Arthas* needs it. *Ul'gruk*'s sealed letter bears his seal, but no one has linked it to him yet.

The Suspects (to Open Ep. 5)

When *Sylvanas* reads *Ul'gruk*'s letter, she knows the traitor is a magister. Only three have had access to the seal and the runes. They are introduced in Ep. 4 and investigated in Ep. 5.

Magister	What he seems	The truth
Belanor Dawnfire	Arrogant; scorns the rangers in public	Merely proud; loyal to King Anasterian
Seraphel Duskfall	Absent at night; coded messages	Secretly smuggles children out of villages in danger
Dar'Khan Drathir	Helpful, flawless, the only one helping	He is the traitor

The dramatic irony must work here: many players will know that *Dar'Khan* is the traitor, but the characters have no proof. The challenge of Ep. 5 will not be guessing it, but proving it in time.



Episode 5:

The Sanctum of the Moon

> *"How do you fight someone who watched you grow up?"*
> — Sylvanas Windrunner

The characters prove that *Dar'Khan* is the traitor and unmask him at the *Sanctum of the Moon*. It is their greatest achievement, and it is what precipitates the tragedy: cornered, *Dar'Khan* puts out the runes and opens the way for *Arthas* ahead of time. **Peripeteia**: *Sylvanas* decides to stay.

Lore moment. *The Scourge* presses toward the inner gates of the kingdom. Fifth milestone of the Clock. In canon, *Dar'Khan* eases *Arthas*'s way through the magical defenses.

Structure

1. **The investigation.** In camp and in *Tranquillien*, against the clock (mechanics below).
2. **Minor encounter: the apprentice's silence.** *Dar'Khan* sends assassins to eliminate *Ilthanar*. The characters arrive in time if they have followed the clues, or hear him scream if not.
3. **The testimony of *Ilthanar*.** He reveals *Arthas*'s true plan (text below).
4. **Main encounter: the *Sanctum of the Moon*.** They surprise *Dar'Khan* meeting with an emissary of the Cult (or with *Ul'gruk*, if he escaped in Ep. 4). Combat and unmasking.
5. ***Dar'Khan*'s escape and the fall of the runes.** Triumph turns into catastrophe.
6. **The confidence and the decision.** *Sylvanas* speaks of *Alleria* and decides to stay.

Investigation Mechanics

- **Investigation clock: 4 segments.** Each investigative action uses one up: questioning someone, searching a set of rooms, following someone at night, examining the runes, deciphering *Ul'gruk*'s letter.
- **Proof.** It takes **3 pieces of proof against *Dar'Khan*** to convince *Sylvanas* to act. False leads also take up time.
- **If they fail**, *Ilthanar* seeks them out on his own, terrified, and takes them to the Sanctum: the story moves forward all the same, but with less advantage in the fight (*Dar'Khan* will not be surprised).



Suspect	Clues that can be found	Conclusion
Belanor Dawnfire	Insults the rangers; holds letters from King Anasterian	False lead: pride, not treason
Seraphel Duskfall	Goes out at night; carries coded messages	False lead: he rescues children from the villages. In exchange for silence, he reveals that Dar'Khan's apprentice is afraid of his master (counts as 1 proof)
Dar'Khan Drathir	The scarlet wax matches the letter's; the runes he "repaired" answer to his voice; Ilthanar's fear; a night outing toward the Sanctum	Each clue is 1 proof

Text: Ilthanar's testimony

The apprentice hugs his knees in a corner, still trembling.

—He doesn't want the kingdom. Neither of them does. The dead prince hasn't come to conquer us. He has come for the Sunwell. —He swallows—. He carries the remains of a man, a necromancer. He wants to bathe them in the Well to bring him back to life. My master has promised him the way. And afterwards... afterwards they will go to Dalaran. They are looking for a book. Medivh's.

He hands you a silver seal, his master's seal, torn from his desk.

—No one will believe me. I'm an apprentice. But they will believe this.

Text: the unmasking at the Sanctum

Dar'Khan is not surprised to see you. He turns slowly, with the same courtesy as ever, like a teacher interrupted in the middle of a lesson.

—You arrive late, as befits the Alliance. —He smiles—. Do you know how many centuries I have served a royal family that prefers rangers and their trees to those who sustain its magic? Anasterian denied me everything. Prince Arthas offers me the Well itself. It is not treason. It is justice.

The runes on his rings light up. In the basin, the reflection of the moons turns green.

Combat. *Dar'Khan*, his arcane guardians and the Cult emissary. If the characters gathered 3 pieces of proof, they act first and with surprise.

Guaranteed escape. When *Dar'Khan* drops to half his hit points, or in the fourth round, he speaks a word: all the runes he "repaired" go out at once, and he sinks into the basin as if through a portal. Canon needs him alive.

Text: the fall of the runes

In the distance, in the forest, one light after another goes out, like candles blown out by a single breath. First the stone you defended. Then the next one. Then all of them.

For a moment, nothing happens. Then, on the horizon, the black stain of the Scourge begins to move. Fast. Faster than ever. There is nothing left to stop it.

Halduron comes running, out of breath.

—You've unmasked him —he says—. And he has opened the gate.

This is the seed of the anagnorisis: their victory has hastened the fall. Better not to underline it; it is enough for Halduron to say it.

Text: the fear

—A magister. —Sylvanas repeats it as if the word burned her—. I can fight the dead. The trolls. A mad prince with a cursed sword. But how do you fight someone who watched you grow up?

She falls silent for a long while. When she speaks again, she looks at the fire, not at you.

—The empty frame at the Spire was Alleria's. My older sister. She crossed the Dark Portal with the humans to end the war in its own world. She never came back. Everyone says she is dead. I don't say it. —She breathes—. If I fall, Vereesa is left alone. That is the only thing I am truly afraid of.

And then, more quietly, almost to herself:

—That is why I am not going to fall.

Text: the decision

At dawn, Sylvanas gathers her officers around the map. Her voice is her own again: cold, precise, without a crack.

—Without the runes, Silvermoon has two days. Maybe three. The king will not evacuate; he doesn't know how. So someone has to win those days for the city. —She puts her finger on the last pass before the gates—. Here.

—General —says Lor'themar—. The plan was to fall back behind the walls.

—The plan was that there'd be no traitor. —She doesn't look at him—. The rangers hold the pass. I with them.

Lor'themar opens his mouth. Closes it. Nods.

Then Sylvanas turns to you, and something changes in her bearing, as if she were taking off an armor no one could see.

—And you will do something harder than dying with me. Ready the refugees. And look after the apprentice. What he knows is worth more than all my bows.

Wrap-up. The characters stay at level 5. The *Scourge* Clock marks the siege of *Silvermoon*. What the players don't know yet is that they have just said goodbye to her.

Episode 6: The Gates of Silvermoon

> *"Someone has to stay so that you can leave. That's the job."*
> — Sylvanas Windrunner

A fighting retreat, not a victory. The characters fight beside *Sylvanas* for the last time, receive her order, lead the convoy out of the burning forest and, from afar, watch her fall. There is no way back.

Lore moment. *Arthas* breaks the last defense and enters *Silvermoon*. Sixth milestone of the Clock. *Sylvanas* dies and is raised as a banshee. What follows (the *Sunwell*, *Anasterian*, *Kel'Thuzad*) is left for the epilogue.

Structure

1. **Minor encounter: the last line.** A brief fight beside *Sylvanas* and her rangers at the pass, while the refugees gather behind. It is the last shared fight: let her guard their backs, let her shout a warning to them by name. Rangers the players know fall (*Velendris*, *Saelis*).
2. **The final order** (text below). *Sylvanas* gives them the letter for *Vereesa* and orders them to go.
3. **Main encounter: the convoy.** The flight along the forest path (mechanics below).
4. **The crag.** From above, they watch *Sylvanas*'s transformation (text below).
5. **Interlude in *Dalaran*** (text below).
6. **Epilogue.**

Convoy Mechanics

- **The convoy has 10 groups of refugees.** Each unresolved threat costs 1 or 2 groups. At the end, the survivors are counted: the number will appear in the epilogue.
- ***Ilthanar* cannot die.** If he is in danger, someone has to step in, at the cost of damage, of a group of refugees or of *Taeren*. It is a choice that weighs, not a failure.
- ***Lor'themar* guides** but doesn't fight on the front line: his job is to keep the convoy on course.

Scene	Threat	How it is resolved
1	The burning forest blocks the path	Survival or Athletics checks to clear the way; a spell can help
2	Gargoyles flying over the convoy	Ranged combat; each gargoyle that reaches the convoy carries off a group
3	A rope bridge over a gorge	Get the refugees across in good order; failing costs a group
4	Arthas's herald (or Ul'gruk, if he escaped in Ep. 4) blocks the road	The episode's final duel

The duel with the herald. If it is the paladin from the *Chapel of the Dawn*, when he falls he may recover an instant of himself: *"Tell the chapel I did not forget it."* If it is *Ul'gruk*, he dies calling out to *Ner'zhul*, who does not answer.

Why they cannot go back. While the convoy crosses the rope bridge, the fire reaches it and it collapses behind them. What they see from the crag can no longer be undone. If a player wants to go back anyway, *Lor'themar* bars the way: *"If you go back, she will have died for nothing."* The player is not stopped: they are made to see the cost.

Taeren. Depending on the version chosen, he obeys and survives with the convoy, or disobeys and stays with her. In the second case, in the crag scene the players make out, beside the silver figure, a smaller one that also keeps shooting to the end.

The Letter for Vereesa (Optional, a Player Handout)

Only if a player reads it, or at the end of the campaign as a keepsake.

> Vereesa:
>
> If you are reading this, these strangers have kept their word. Treat them well; they fought for us better than many of our own.
>
> Don't cry more than you need to. Mother wouldn't have wanted it, and neither do I. I did what she taught us: stay so that others could leave.

If Alleria ever comes back, and she will, because she is too stubborn to die far from home, tell her I kept her frame on the wall. And that the swing is still there.

A ranger doesn't die in the forest. She stays in it.

Your sister, Sylvanas

Text: the final order

The forest burns behind you. Sylvanas finds you on the forest path, with the refugee convoy behind and young Ilthanar trembling among them.

—Lor'themar will guide you. He knows the way. —She puts a sealed scroll in your hands—. For Vereesa. In Dalaran. Don't read it, though it wouldn't kill you to.

—Come with us —someone says.

Sylvanas smiles, and for an instant she is the woman of the swing.

—Someone has to stay so that you can leave. That's the job. My mother did it. Now it's my turn. —She turns to her rangers—. Taeren, you go with them.

—General, I...

—That's an order. —She doesn't look at him—. Someone has to tell how you didn't fall back today.

She walks into the smoke without looking back. As always.

Hard variant: Taeren disobeys and stays with her; the players see him turn around on the path.

Text: the transformation (seen from a crag, or in a vision through the Windrunner arrow)

The gates have fallen. From the heights you see the black column enter Silvermoon, and in its midst a silver figure, the last one still shooting.

She falls. Arthas dismounts slowly, like someone in no hurry. He bends over her. He does not finish her.

What happens next has no name. A cold light leaves the body as if someone were pulling a thread. The body stays on the ground. What rises is no longer her: it is a scream in the shape of a woman, pale, suspended in the air, looking at her own hands that are no longer hands.

You have seen her eyes on many nights by the fire. Now they have no color.

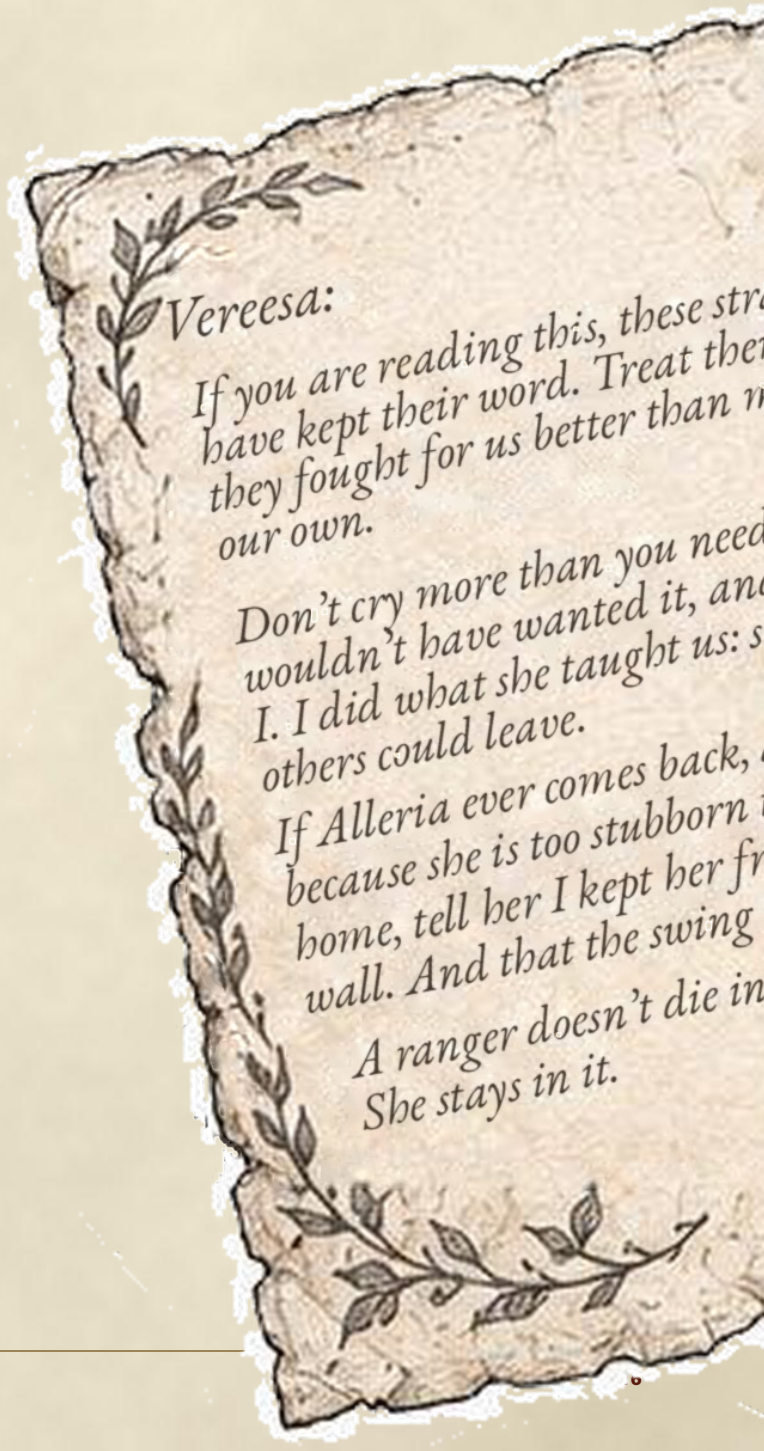
She screams. You hear it from here. The forest hears it.

Text: interlude in *Dalaran* (narrative license, not canon)

Far from there, in a room in Dalaran, a silver-haired elf wakes with a start. She does not know why. The night is calm, the stars in their places. But the bow hanging on the wall has let go of its string, by itself, with a dry snap, as if something had broken in the world.

Vereesa Windrunner stares at the bow until dawn. Her mother died defending Quel'Thalas. Her older sister was lost beyond the Dark Portal. Tonight, without knowing it yet, she has been left alone.

And on some road to the south, a few strangers from the Alliance carry in their hands her sister's last letter, without knowing how they will deliver it.



Epilogue

> *"But banshees do not forget."*
> — To be read at the end of the last session

To be read at the end of the last session, without interruptions. Replace **[N]** with the number of refugee groups that survived the convoy.

You reached Dalaran with [N] groups of refugees, an apprentice who would not stop trembling and a letter you had not read. They believed you. The silver seal left no room for doubt. The mages of the Kirin Tor reinforced their towers, consulted their books, raised their shields. It was no use.

Because while you were walking south, Prince Arthas had reached the Sunwell. There, King Anasterian, too old to flee and too proud to surrender, rose against him, and died as all the others had died. Arthas immersed in the sacred waters the remains he carried in his father's urn, and from the Well, poisoned forever, rose Kel'Thuzad, turned into something that was no longer a man. The magic that had nourished the elves for seven thousand years was left rotten at its source.

The road the Scourge opened from the gates to the Well never healed. The earth stayed black, dead, like a scar cut with a knife across the golden forest. They would call it the Dead Scar. The half of Silvermoon it crossed would remain in ruins forever: the Ruins of Silvermoon. And the south of Eversong Woods, where you defended bridges and runestones, where the Ranger-General sat you by her fire, would become a land of shadows and of dead who do not rest. The Ghostlands.

Further south, the eastern lands of Lordaeron, where you followed a warlock's trail so recently, would rot under the plague until they lost their name. They would become the Eastern Plaguelands. Only a small chapel would hold out there. Years later, its defenders would win a victory there so impossible that the place would change its name. From then on, the Chapel of the Dawn would be Light's Hope Chapel.

Dalaran fell soon after. The Book of Medivh was opened, and a demon set foot on Azeroth. Prince Arthas went on his way north, toward the ice, toward a throne that awaited him atop a glacier, where one day he would become the Lich King.

Lor'themar Theron gathered the few who remained and lit again the lights of what was left of Silvermoon. Vereesa Windrunner received a letter and kept it beside a stringless bow. Alleria, whom everyone took for dead, was still somewhere beyond the Dark Portal, knowing nothing.

And Sylvanas Windrunner, Ranger-General of Silvermoon, daughter of Lireesa, who brought down the bridges of the Elrendar and saluted the prince of Lordaeron with her bow, had no grave. Her body stayed in the forest. What remained of her marched after Arthas, chained to his will, condemned to serve the man who had destroyed everything she loved.

But banshees do not forget. And she, who never fell back, learned to wait.

A ranger doesn't die in the forest. She stays in it.



Appendix A: Stat Blocks

> *"You have seen her eyes on many nights by the fire."*
> — Episode 6

The stat blocks follow the format of the 2024 edition of the rules (5.5). They are tuned for a group of four or five characters of levels 3 to 5, except for the high-level characters, who keep their true power. All values are provisional until the setting's sourcebook is published.

Abbreviations. AC: Armor Class. HP: Hit Points. CR: Challenge Rating. XP: experience points. PB: Proficiency Bonus. DC: Difficulty Class. MOD: modifier. SAVE: saving throw.

Stat Blocks by Challenge Rating

Character	CR	Episodes
Arthas Menethil	22	3, 6
Sylvanas Windrunner	14	2–6
Lor'themar Theron	10	2–6
Dar'Khan Drathir	7	4, 5
Halduron Brightwing	6	2–6
The herald, fallen knight	6	1, 4, 6
Ul'gruk	5	2, 4–6
Velendris	4	2–6
Belanor Dawnfire	4	4, 5
Vereesa Windrunner	3	6
Seraphel Duskfall	3	4, 5
Cult emissary	3	5
Aelyra	2	2–6
Cult acolyte	2	1
Arcane guardian	2	5
Dar'Khan's assassin	2	5
Felsteed	2	4, 6
Saelis	1	2–6
Silvermoon ranger	1	2–6
Taeren	1/2	2–6
Ilthanar	1/8	5, 6

High-Level Characters

Arthas, Sylvanas and Lor'themar have their true power here. They are not meant for the group to fight, nor to resolve fights in place of the players: their stat blocks are there so you know what they can do when the scene calls for it.



Arthas Menethil



Prince of Lordaeron, death knight · Episodes 3 and 6

Arthas is the unstoppable force of the tragedy. The characters only see him from afar: on the bank of the Elrendar and over the body of Sylvanas. His stat block exists as a reference, so the GM knows why no one can stop him.

If the characters attack him

There should be no fight. If someone throws themselves at him, Arthas doesn't bother to kill them: one gesture and the character is flung away, with 1 hit point and the aura of winter in their bones. Lor'themar drags them back to the path.

Arthas Menethil

Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Evil

AC 21 (runed plate armor)

Initiative +9 (19)

HP 420 (40d8 + 240)

Speed 30 ft. (60 ft. riding Invincible)

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	24	+7	+14	**DEX**	14	+2	+2	**CON**	22	+6	+13
INT	16	+3	+3	**WIS**	18	+4	+11	**CHA**	22	+6	+13

Skills Athletics +14, History +10, Intimidation +13, Perception +11, Religion +10

Immunities Cold, Necrotic, Poison; Exhaustion, Frightened, Poisoned, Charmed

Senses Darkvision 120 ft., Truesight 30 ft.; Passive Perception 21

Languages Common, Dwarvish, Thalassian; telepathy with the Lich King and with the undead of the Scourge within 1 mile

CR 22 (XP 41,000; PB +7)

Traits

Legendary Resistance (4/Day). If he fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

Aura of Winter. Any hostile creature that starts its turn within 10 feet of Arthas must succeed on a DC 21 Constitution saving throw or take 10 (3d6) Cold damage, and its Speed is reduced by 10 feet until the start of its next turn.

Soulless. Divination spells reveal nothing about Arthas, and no magic can read his thoughts.

Voice of the Lich King. Allied undead within 120 feet that can hear him have advantage on saving throws and are immune to the Frightened condition.

Actions

Multiattack. Arthas makes three attacks with *Frostmourne*. He can replace one of them with a use of *Death Coil*, if available.

Frostmourne. *Melee Attack Roll:* +17, reach 5 ft.
Hit: 23 (3d8 + 10) Slashing damage plus 18 (4d8) Cold damage. A creature reduced to 0 Hit Points by this attack dies instantly and its soul is trapped in the sword (see Appendix B).

Death Coil (Recharge 5–6). *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 21, one creature Arthas can see within 120 feet. *Failure:* 55 (10d10) Necrotic damage. *Success:* Half damage. If the target is an allied undead, it regains that many Hit Points instead.

Raise the Dead (1/Day). Arthas raises as ghouls under his control up to ten corpses of Medium or Small Humanoids within 60 feet. They act immediately after him in the initiative order.

Bonus Actions

Death Grip. *Strength Saving Throw:* DC 21, one creature Arthas can see within 60 feet. *Failure:* The target is pulled in a straight line to an unoccupied space within 5 feet of Arthas and has the Grappled condition (escape DC 21).

Reactions

Anti-Magic Shell. *Trigger:* Arthas is targeted by a spell or is in its area. *Response:* He has advantage on the saving throw against that spell and resistance to its damage.

Legendary Actions

Legendary Action Uses: 3. Immediately after another creature's turn, Arthas can expend a use to take one of the following actions. He regains all expended uses at the start of each of his turns.

Frost Strike. Arthas makes one attack with *Frostmourne*.

Command the Scourge. Up to three allied undead that can hear him use their reaction to move up to their Speed or make one attack.

Relentless Advance. Arthas moves up to half his Speed without provoking opportunity attacks. The grass withers where he passes.

Sylvanas Windrunner

Ranger-General of Silvermoon · Episodes 2 to 6 · Ally

She saves the group in Episode 2 and fights beside them in episodes 4 and 6. Her stat block shows Quel'Thalas's finest archer at her peak: all that Arthas will destroy.

Sylvanas at the table

She is an ally, not a protagonist. She always acts last in the round and uses *Volley* and *Tactical Command* to clear minions and open opportunities for the characters, never to defeat the main enemy. Until Episode 6 she cannot fall: if she reaches 0 hit points, she leaves the scene, wounded. In Episode 6 her death is not played: it is narrated.



Sylvanas Windrunner

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Chaotic Good

AC 18 (elven studded leather)
Initiative +11 (21)
HP 210 (28d8 + 84)
Speed 40 ft., Climb 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	12	+1	+1	**DEX**	22	+6	+11	**CON**	16	+3	+3
INT	14	+2	+2	**WIS**	18	+4	+9	**CHA**	18	+4	+9

Skills Athletics +6, Intimidation +9, Perception +14, Insight +9, Stealth +16, Survival +9
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 24
Languages Common, Thalassian, Zandali
CR 14 (XP 11,500; PB +5)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Legendary Resistance (3/Day). If she fails a saving throw, she can choose to succeed instead.

Ranger-General. While Sylvanas isn't Incapacitated, allied rangers within 60 feet that can see or hear her have advantage on saving throws against the Frightened condition and add 1d4 to their attack rolls.

Peerless Marksman. Her ranged attacks don't have disadvantage at long range or for being within 5 feet of an enemy, and they ignore half cover and three-quarters cover.

Actions

Multiattack. Sylvanas makes three attacks with the *White Bow of the Windrunners* or the *Elven Sword*, in any combination. She can replace all three attacks with a use of *Volley*.

White Bow of the Windrunners. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +13, range 150/600 ft. *Hit:* 12 (1d8 + 8) Piercing damage plus 7 (2d6) Radiant damage.

Elven Sword. *Melee Attack Roll:* +11, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 9 (1d6 + 6) Slashing damage.

Volley (Recharge 5–6). Sylvanas looses a rain of arrows over a 20-foot-radius, 30-foot-high Cylinder centered on a point she can see within 150 feet. *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 19, each creature of her choice in the Cylinder. *Failure:* 31 (7d8) Piercing damage. *Success:* Half damage.

Bonus Actions

Fade into the Forest. Sylvanas takes the Hide action, even if she is only lightly obscured by foliage, mist or dim light.

Tactical Command (3/Day). One allied ranger who can hear her uses their reaction to move up to their Speed without provoking opportunity attacks or to make one attack.

Reactions

Fleeting Step. *Trigger:* An attack roll Sylvanas can see hits her. *Response:* She halves the damage and moves up to 10 feet without provoking opportunity attacks.

Lor'themar Theron

Ranger lieutenant · Episodes 2 to 6 · Ally

The shadow of Sylvanas and the convoy's guide in Episode 6. He survives the fall: in canon he will become regent of Quel'Thalas.

Lor'themar Theron

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Lawful Good

AC 17 (studded leather)
Initiative +9 (19)
HP 170 (20d8 + 80)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	16	+3	+3	**DEX**	20	+5	+9	**CON**	18	+4	+8
INT	14	+2	+2	**WIS**	16	+3	+7	**CHA**	15	+2	+2

Skills Athletics +7, Perception +11, Insight +7, Stealth +9, Survival +7

Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 21
Languages Common, Thalassian, Zandali
CR 10 (XP 5,900; PB +4)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Telling Blow (1/Turn). When Lor'themar hits with an attack, the target takes an extra 13 (3d8) damage of the same type.

Lieutenant. If Sylvanas is absent or Incapacitated, Lor'themar grants her *Ranger-General* trait to allied rangers.

Convoy Guide. While he guides a group through the forest, the group can't become lost except by magical means and has advantage on Wisdom (Survival) checks to find its way.

Actions

Multiattack. Lor'themar makes three attacks with the *Silvermoon Blade* or the *Longbow*, in any combination.

Silvermoon Blade. *Melee Attack Roll:* +9, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 10 (1d10 + 5) Slashing damage.

Longbow. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +9, range 150/600 ft. *Hit:* 9 (1d8 + 5) Piercing damage.

Multishot (Recharge 5–6). Lor'themar makes one attack with the *Longbow* against each creature of his choice, up to four, that he can see within 60 feet.

Bonus Actions

Order to Withdraw. Up to five allies within 60 feet who can hear him move up to half their Speed without provoking opportunity attacks.

Reactions

Parry. *Trigger:* A melee attack roll hits Lor'themar. *Response:* He adds 3 to his AC against that attack, possibly causing it to miss.



The Rangers of Silvermoon

Allies who fight beside the group between episodes 2 and 6. Keep their stat blocks at hand: the bond with them is also built on the battlefield.

Velendris



Veteran ranger · Episodes 2 to 6 · Ally

The best archer after Sylvanas, and one of the first to fall on the last line in Episode 6.

Velendris

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Neutral Good

AC 16 (studded leather)
Initiative +4 (14)
HP 75 (10d8 + 30)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	12	+1	+1	DEX	18	+4	+6	CON	16	+3	+3
INT	12	+1	+1	WIS	16	+3	+5	CHA	10	+0	+0

Skills Perception +7, Stealth +6, Survival +5
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 17
Languages Common, Thalassian
CR 4 (XP 1,100; PB +2)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Veteran's Eye. Her ranged attacks ignore half cover and three-quarters cover.

Actions

Multiattack. Velendris makes three attacks with the *Longbow*.

Longbow. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +6, range 150/600 ft. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) Piercing damage.

Shortsword. *Melee Attack Roll:* +6, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d6 + 4) Piercing damage.

Neck Shot (Recharge 5–6). Velendris makes one attack with the *Longbow*. On a hit, the target takes an extra 13 (3d8) Piercing damage; a Medium or smaller undead left with 20 Hit Points or fewer is destroyed.

Halduron Brightwing

Ranger · Episodes 2 to 6 · Ally

The warm counterpoint of the command group, and probably the first elf to trust the characters. He is the one who speaks the line of the anagnorisis in Episode 5.

Halduron Brightwing

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Chaotic Good

AC 16 (studded leather)
Initiative +7 (17)
HP 104 (16d8 + 32)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	12	+1	+1	DEX	18	+4	+7	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	12	+1	+1	WIS	14	+2	+5	CHA	16	+3	+3

Skills Acrobatics +7, Performance +6, Perception +8, Stealth +7, Survival +5
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 18
Languages Common, Thalassian
CR 6 (XP 2,300; PB +3)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Good Cheer. At the end of a Short Rest spent with Halduron, his allies gain 1d6 + 3 Temporary Hit Points.

Actions

Multiattack. Halduron makes three attacks with the *Longbow* or the *Scimitar*, in any combination.

Longbow. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +7, range 150/600 ft. *Hit:* 8 (1d8 + 4) Piercing damage plus 3 (1d6) Piercing damage.

Scimitar. *Melee Attack Roll:* +7, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d6 + 4) Slashing damage.

Bonus Actions

Encouragement. One ally within 30 feet who can hear him has advantage on their next attack roll or ability check before the end of their next turn.

Reactions

Distraction. *Trigger:* A creature within 30 feet makes an attack roll against one of Halduron's allies. *Response:* The roll has disadvantage: a joke, a shout or an arrow that whistles past.



Aelyra



Keeper of the watches and the fords · Episodes 2 to 6 · Ally

She organizes the camp's watches and defends the fords. Her watch horn is what the characters hear every time the Scourge draws near.

Aelyra

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Lawful Good

AC 15 (chain shirt)
Initiative +2 (12)
HP 52 (8d8 + 16)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	14	+2	+2	DEX	15	+2	+2	CON	14	+2	+4
INT	12	+1	+1	WIS	14	+2	+2	CHA	13	+1	+1

Skills Perception +4, Insight +4, Survival +4
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 14
Languages Common, Thalassian
CR 2 (XP 450; PB +2)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Actions

Multiattack. Aelyra makes two attacks with the *Longsword* or the *Longbow*.

Longsword. *Melee Attack Roll:* +4, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 2) Slashing damage, or 8 (1d10 + 2) if wielded in two hands.

Longbow. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +4, range 150/600 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) Piercing damage.

Bonus Actions

Watch Horn (1/Day). Allies within 60 feet who hear it can use their reaction to move up to 10 feet.

Reactions

Hold the Ford. *Trigger:* An enemy enters a space within 5 feet of Aelyra. *Response:* She makes one attack with the *Longsword*; on a hit, the target's Speed is 0 until the end of the turn.



Ranger · Episodes 2 to 6 · Ally

Always comes back wounded, never bandages himself in time. His stat block is the Silvermoon ranger's plus two traits.

Saelis

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Chaotic Good

AC 14 (leather armor)
Initiative +3 (13)
HP 39 (6d8 + 12)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	12	+1	+1	DEX	16	+3	+3	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	13	+1	+1	CHA	11	+0	+0

Skills Perception +3, Stealth +5, Survival +3
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 13
Languages Common, Thalassian
CR 1 (XP 200; PB +2)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Always Comes Back. The first time in each combat that Saelis drops to 0 Hit Points, he drops to 1 Hit Point instead.

Never Bandages in Time. He starts each combat with 10 Hit Points fewer than his maximum, unless someone has healed him beforehand.

Actions

Multiattack. Saelis makes two attacks with the *Longbow* or the *Shortsword*.

Longbow. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +5, range 150/600 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) Piercing damage.

Shortsword. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) Piercing damage.



Generic stat block · Episodes 2 to 6

For the camp's nameless rangers, the defenses and the last line.

Silvermoon Ranger

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Any Good Alignment

AC 14 (leather armor)
Initiative +3 (13)
HP 33 (6d8 + 6)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	11	+0	+0	**DEX**	16	+3	+3	**CON**	12	+1	+1
INT	11	+0	+0	**WIS**	14	+2	+2	**CHA**	10	+0	+0

Skills Perception +4, Stealth +5, Survival +4
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 14
Languages Common, Thalassian
CR 1 (XP 200; PB +2)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Shooting from Cover. If the ranger is hidden when it makes a ranged attack and misses, its position is not revealed.

Actions

Multiattack. The ranger makes two attacks with the *Longbow* or the *Shortsword*.

Longbow. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +5, range 150/600 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) Piercing damage.

Shortsword. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) Piercing damage.



The youngest ranger · Episodes 2 to 6 · Ally

Barely a boy. He rolls dice in the pursuit of Episode 4 and can end up in danger on the bridge in Episode 3 and in the convoy in Episode 6.

Taeren in the pursuit

Use these bonuses: Acrobatics +5, Athletics +2, Perception +3, Stealth +5, Survival +3; Dexterity save +3 and Wisdom save +1.

Taeren

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Neutral Good

AC 14 (leather armor)
Initiative +3 (13)
HP 22 (5d8)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	10	+0	+0	**DEX**	16	+3	+3	**CON**	10	+0	+0
INT	10	+0	+0	**WIS**	13	+1	+1	**CHA**	12	+1	+1

Skills Acrobatics +5, Athletics +2, Perception +3, Stealth +5, Survival +3
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 13
Languages Common (heavily accented), Thalassian
CR 1/2 (XP 100; PB +2)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Never Falls Back. While he can see Sylvanas, Taeren is immune to the Frightened condition.

Too Brave. If an ally drops to 0 Hit Points within 30 feet of him, Taeren must use his next turn to move toward the nearest enemy.

Actions

Longbow (Too Big for Him). *Ranged Attack Roll:* +5, range 100/300 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) Piercing damage.

Dagger. *Melee or Ranged Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) Piercing damage.

Traitors and Enemies

The adventure's named rivals, tuned for a group of four or five characters of levels 3 to 5.



Traitor magister · Episodes 4 and 5

The boss of Episode 5. He fights alongside two arcane guardians and the Cult emissary, and always escapes: canon needs him alive.

The guaranteed escape

The Word That Extinguishes is not a spell: it can't be countered or dispelled. If the characters gathered three proofs, they act with surprise but can't stop his flight. It is the peripeteia: escaping, he puts out the runes and opens the way for the Scourge.



Dar'Khan Drathir

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Neutral Evil

AC 15 (mage armor)
Initiative +5 (15)
HP 130 (20d8 + 40)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	9	–1	–1	DEX	14	+2	+2	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	20	+5	+8	WIS	14	+2	+5	CHA	16	+3	+3

Skills Arcana +11, Deception +9, History +8, Insight +5, Persuasion +6

Resistances Necrotic
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 12
Languages Common, Thalassian, Ancient Elvish, Nerubian
CR 7 (XP 2,900; PB +3)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Legendary Resistance (2/Day). If he fails a saving throw, he can choose to succeed instead.

The Word That Extinguishes (1/Day). When Dar'Khan is reduced to half his Hit Points or fewer, or at the end of his fourth turn, he speaks a word without using an action: all the runes he has bound go out at once, and he vanishes through the Sanctum's water to a place he knows.

Bound Runes. As a Bonus Action, Dar'Khan can extinguish any rune-stone he has "repaired", as long as he is within 1 mile of it.

Actions

Multiattack. Dar'Khan makes three attacks with *Arcane Bolt*. He can replace one of them with a use of *Spellcasting*.

Arcane Bolt. *Ranged Spell Attack Roll:* +8, range 120 ft. *Hit:* 14 (2d8 + 5) Force damage.

Spellcasting. Dar'Khan casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 16):

At Will: Detect Magic, Mage Hand, Prestidigitation
2/Day Each: Counterspell, Hold Person, Lightning Bolt
1/Day: Greater Invisibility

Bonus Actions

Fel Rune (Recharge 5–6). Dar'Khan traces a rune beneath a creature he can see within 60 feet. *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 16. *Failure:* 18 (4d8) Necrotic damage, and the target has the Prone condition. *Success:* Half damage.

Reactions

Rune Shield (3/Day). *Trigger:* An attack roll hits Dar'Khan, or he is targeted by *Magic Missile*. *Response:* He gains +5 to AC until the start of his next turn, including against the triggering attack, and takes no damage from *Magic Missile*.

The herald, fallen knight

Herald of Arthas · Episodes 1, 4 and 6

The wounded paladin from the Chapel of the Dawn, raised by Arthas as his herald (if you want to give him a name, Sir Aldric suits him). He brings the prince's threat in Episode 4 and may block the convoy's way in Episode 6.

The herald, fallen knight

Medium Undead, Lawful Evil

AC 18 (plate armor)
Initiative +3 (13)
HP 112 (15d8 + 45)
Speed 30 ft. (60 ft. riding his skeletal steed)

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	18	+4	+7	DEX	10	+0	+0	CON	16	+3	+6
INT	10	+0	+0	WIS	13	+1	+4	CHA	15	+2	+2

Resistances Cold
Immunities Necrotic, Poison; Exhaustion, Frightened, Poisoned
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 11
Languages Common
CR 6 (XP 2,300; PB +3)

Traits

Echoes of the Light. The first time in each combat that the herald takes Radiant damage, he has disadvantage on his next attack roll: something in him remembers who he was.

Last Instant. On dropping to 0 Hit Points, the herald recovers his voice for a few seconds before crumbling into frost (see Episode 6).

Actions

Multiattack. The herald makes two attacks with the *Runeblade*.

Runeblade. *Melee Attack Roll:* +7, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) Slashing damage plus 7 (2d6) Cold damage.

Frost Breath (Recharge 5–6). *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 14, each creature in a 15-foot Cone. *Failure:* 22 (5d8) Cold damage, and the target's Speed is 0 until the end of the herald's next turn. *Success:* Half damage.

Reactions

Parry. *Trigger:* A melee attack roll hits the herald. *Response:* He adds 3 to his AC against that attack, possibly causing it to miss.



Ul'gruk Ashtongue

Orc warlock of the Shadow Council · Episodes 2, 4, 5 and 6

The Horde thread. He commands the ambush of Episode 2, flees in the pursuit of Episode 4 and, if he escapes, reappears in Episode 5 or 6.

Ul'gruk in each episode

Episode 2: he fights from atop a crag, with three-quarters cover; he flees as soon as Sylvanas appears. *Episode 4:* if they catch him, he starts the fight with 50 Hit Points and without *Fel Fire Rain* available. *Episode 6:* if he escaped, he has his full Hit Points and is accompanied by a felhound.

Ul'gruk Ashtongue

Medium Humanoid (Orc), Neutral Evil

AC 14 (studded leather)
Initiative +2 (12)
HP 97 (13d8 + 39)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	14	+2	+2	DEX	14	+2	+2	CON	16	+3	+6
INT	13	+1	+1	WIS	12	+1	+4	CHA	18	+4	+4

Skills Arcana +4, Deception +7, Intimidation +7, Stealth +5
Resistances Fire
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 11
Languages Orc, Common, Demonic
CR 5 (XP 1,800; PB +3)

Traits

Faith in the King of Cold. He has advantage on saving throws against the Frightened and Charmed conditions.

Ash Talisman. Ul'gruk carries the talisman described in Appendix B and can use its properties without suffering its curse: he has already paid its price.

Actions

Multiattack. Ul'gruk makes two attacks with *Shadow Bolt*.

Shadow Bolt. *Ranged Spell Attack Roll:* +7, range 120 ft. *Hit:* 15 (2d10 + 4) Necrotic damage.

Fel Fire Rain (Recharge 5–6). *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 15, each creature in a 15-foot-radius, 20-foot-high Cylinder centered on a point within 120 feet. *Failure:* 27 (6d8) Fire damage. *Success:* Half damage.

Spellcasting. Ul'gruk casts one of the following spells, using Charisma as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 15):

At Will: Mage Hand, Thaumaturgy
1/Day Each: Fear, Darkness

Bonus Actions

Veil of Smoke (Recharge 4–6). Ul'gruk exhales black smoke: a 10-foot-radius Sphere centered on him is Heavily Obscured until the start of his next turn.

Reactions

Fel Pact. *Trigger:* Ul'gruk takes damage while an allied Fiend is within 30 feet. *Response:* The Fiend takes half of that damage instead.

Emissary of the Cult of the Damned

The Cult's liaison with Dar'Khan · Episode 5

He accompanies Dar'Khan at the Sanctum of the Moon, unless Ul'gruk takes his place.

Emissary of the Cult of the Damned

Medium Humanoid (Human), Neutral Evil

AC 13 (leather armor)
Initiative +2 (12)
HP 58 (13d8)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	10	+0	+0	**DEX**	14	+2	+2	**CON**	10	+0	+0
INT	12	+1	+1	**WIS**	16	+3	+5	**CHA**	14	+2	+2

Skills Deception +4, Religion +3
Senses Passive Perception 13
Languages Common, Thalassian
CR 3 (XP 700; PB +2)

Traits

Dark Faith. Advantage on saving throws against the Frightened condition.

Actions

Multiattack. The emissary makes two attacks with *Plague Ray*.

Plague Ray. *Ranged Spell Attack Roll:* +5, range 90 ft. *Hit:* 12 (2d8 + 3) Necrotic damage.

Pestilent Cloud (Recharge 5–6). *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 13, each creature in a 10-foot-radius Sphere centered on a point within 60 feet. *Failure:* 18 (4d8) Poison damage, and the target has the Poisoned condition until the end of its next turn. *Success:* Half damage.

Reactions

Martyr of the Scourge. *Trigger:* The emissary drops to 0 Hit Points. *Response:* He bursts into a cloud of ash. *Constitution Saving Throw:* DC 13, each creature within 10 feet. *Failure:* 10 (3d6) Necrotic damage. *Success:* Half damage.

Acolyte of the Cult of the Damned

Ul'gruk's envoy · Episode 1

He leads the assault in waves against the Chapel of the Dawn. On his body are the map of the runestones and the fragment of sealing wax.

Acolyte of the Cult of the Damned

Medium Humanoid (Human), Neutral Evil

AC 12 (leather armor)
Initiative +1 (11)
HP 45 (10d8)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	10	+0	+0	**DEX**	12	+1	+1	**CON**	10	+0	+0
INT	13	+1	+1	**WIS**	15	+2	+4	**CHA**	11	+0	+0

Skills Deception +2, Religion +3
Senses Passive Perception 12
Languages Common
CR 2 (XP 450; PB +2)

Traits

Dark Faith. Advantage on saving throws against the Frightened condition.

Actions

Multiattack. The acolyte makes two attacks with the *Sacrificial Dagger* or *Necrotic Ray*.

Sacrificial Dagger. *Melee Attack Roll:* +3, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) Piercing damage plus 5 (2d4) Necrotic damage.

Necrotic Ray. *Ranged Spell Attack Roll:* +4, range 60 ft. *Hit:* 9 (2d6 + 2) Necrotic damage.

Spellcasting. The acolyte casts one of the following spells, using Wisdom as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12):

At Will: Thaumaturgy
1/Day Each: Hold Person, Darkness

Bonus Actions

Command the Dead. One allied undead within 30 feet that can hear him moves up to half its Speed.



Arcane guardian

Dar'Khan's escort · Episode 5

Constructs of stone and runes that protect the magister at the Sanctum. He has two.

Arcane guardian

Medium Construct, Unaligned

AC 16 (natural armor)
Initiative +0 (10)
HP 45 (6d8 + 18)
Speed 20 ft., Fly 20 ft. (hover)

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	16	+3	+3	DEX	10	+0	+0	CON	16	+3	+3
INT	3	−4	−4	WIS	10	+0	+0	CHA	1	−5	−5

Immunities Psychic, Poison; Exhaustion, Frightened, Poisoned, Charmed, Paralyzed
Senses Blindsight 30 ft.; Passive Perception 10
Languages understands Thalassian but can't speak
CR 2 (XP 450; PB +2)

Traits

Bond with the Magister. While Dar'Khan is within 10 feet of the guardian, half the damage Dar'Khan takes is transferred to the guardian.

Masterless. If Dar'Khan leaves the fight, the guardian has the Incapacitated condition.

Actions

Multiattack. The guardian makes two attacks with the *Rune Fist*.

Rune Fist. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) Force damage.

Reactions

Intercept. *Trigger:* A creature the guardian can see attacks Dar'Khan while the guardian is within 5 feet of him. *Response:* The guardian becomes the target of the attack.

Dar'Khan's assassin

In the magister's pay · Episode 5

Sent to silence Ilthanar. For four or five characters of level 5, use three.

Dar'Khan's assassin

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Neutral Evil

AC 15 (studded leather)
Initiative +5 (15)
HP 39 (6d8 + 12)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	10	+0	+0	DEX	16	+3	+3	CON	14	+2	+2
INT	12	+1	+1	WIS	12	+1	+1	CHA	10	+0	+0

Skills Acrobatics +5, Perception +3, Stealth +7
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 13
Languages Common, Thalassian
CR 2 (XP 450; PB +2)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Sneak Attack (1/Turn). The assassin deals an extra 7 (2d6) damage when it hits with advantage, or when one of its allies is within 5 feet of the target.

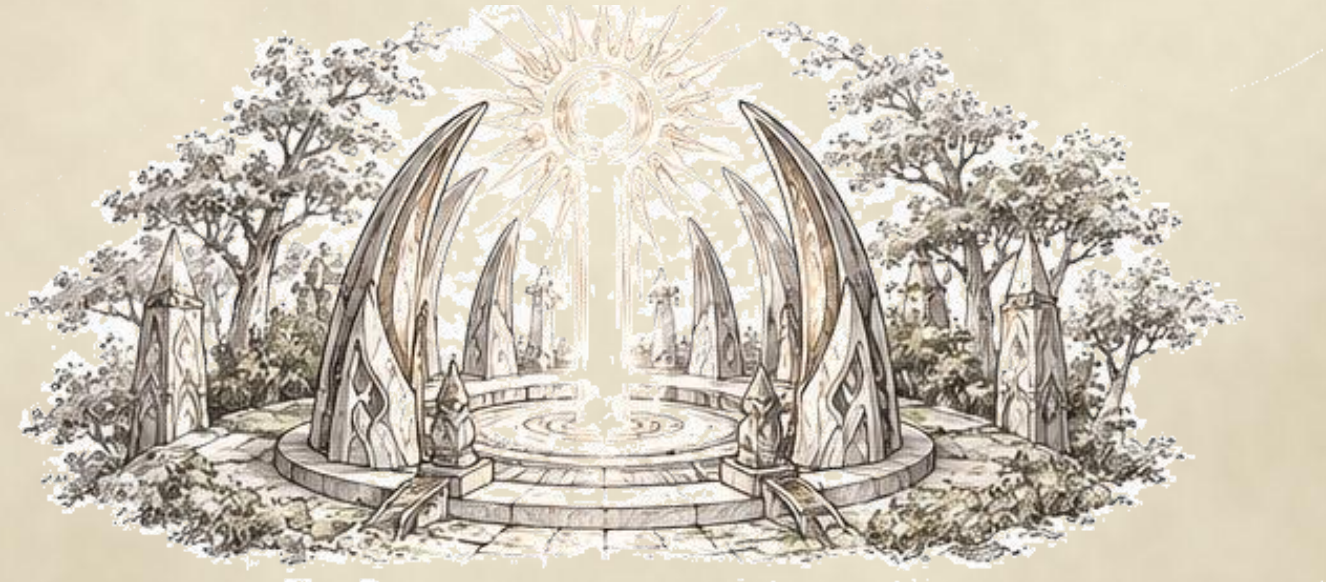
Actions

Multiattack. The assassin makes two attacks with the *Poisoned Dagger*.

Poisoned Dagger. *Melee or Ranged Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) Piercing damage plus 5 (2d4) Poison damage.

Bonus Actions

Cunning Retreat. The assassin takes the Disengage or Hide action.



Other Characters

Characters who shouldn't fight, but whose stat blocks may be needed if a scene goes wrong, or for a possible sequel.

Belanor Dawnfire

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Lawful Neutral

AC 12 (15 with mage armor)
Initiative +2 (12)
HP 66 (12d8 + 12)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	9	−1	−1	**DEX**	14	+2	+2	**CON**	12	+1	+1
INT	18	+4	+6	**WIS**	12	+1	+3	**CHA**	16	+3	+3

Skills Arcana +6, History +6, Intimidation +5, Persuasion +5
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 11
Languages Common, Thalassian, Ancient Elvish
CR 4 (XP 1,100; PB +2)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Magister's Pride. He has disadvantage on Wisdom (Insight) checks to discern the intentions of anyone who flatters him.

Actions

Multiattack. Belanor makes two attacks with *Fire Ray*.

Fire Ray. *Ranged Spell Attack Roll:* +6, range 120 ft. *Hit:* 13 (2d10 + 2) Fire damage.

Spellcasting. Belanor casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 14):

At Will: Detect Magic, Mage Hand
1/Day Each: Mage Armor, Fireball, Counterspell

Reactions

Shield (2/Day). *Trigger:* An attack roll hits Belanor. *Response:* He gains +5 to AC until the start of his next turn, including against the triggering attack.

Vereesa Windrunner

The younger sister · Episode 6 interlude

She does not appear on stage: only in the Dalaran interlude. Her stat block may be useful if the delivery of the letter is played in a sequel.

Vereesa Windrunner

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Neutral Good

AC 15 (studded leather)
Initiative +3 (13)
HP 58 (9d8 + 18)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	10	+0	+0	**DEX**	17	+3	+5	**CON**	14	+2	+2
INT	14	+2	+2	**WIS**	13	+1	+1	**CHA**	14	+2	+2

Skills Arcana +4, Perception +3, Stealth +5
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 13
Languages Common, Thalassian
CR 3 (XP 700; PB +2)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Actions

Multiattack. Vereesa makes two attacks with the *Longbow* or the *Shortsword*.

Longbow. *Ranged Attack Roll:* +5, range 150/600 ft. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) Piercing damage.

Shortsword. *Melee Attack Roll:* +5, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) Piercing damage.

Spellcasting. Vereesa casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12):

At Will: Light, Mage Hand
1/Day Each: Shield, Magic Missile



Seraphel Duskfall

Suspect magistrix · Episodes 4 and 5

The other false lead: she slips out at night with coded messages, secretly smuggling children out of endangered villages.

Seraphel Duskfall

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Neutral Good

AC 12
Initiative +2 (12)
HP 49 (11d8)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	8	−1	−1	**DEX**	14	+2	+2	**CON**	10	+0	+0
INT	17	+3	+5	**WIS**	13	+1	+1	**CHA**	14	+2	+2

Skills Arcana +5, Deception +4, Insight +3, Stealth +4
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 11
Languages Common, Thalassian
CR 3 (XP 700; PB +2)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

Actions

Multiattack. Seraphel makes two attacks with *Dusk Dart*.

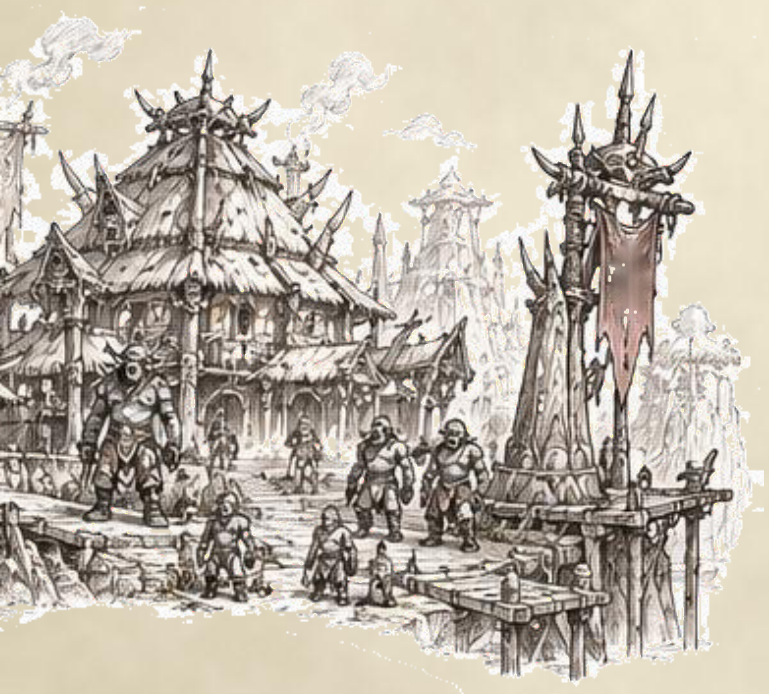
Dusk Dart. *Ranged Spell Attack Roll:* +5, range 90 ft. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) Psychic damage.

Spellcasting. Seraphel casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 13):

At Will: Minor Illusion, Mage Hand
2/Day: Invisibility
1/Day: Major Image

Reactions

Vanish (1/Day). *Trigger:* An attack roll hits Seraphel. *Response:* She teleports up to 30 feet to an unoccupied space she can see and has the Invisible condition until the start of her next turn.



Ilthanar

The witness · Episodes 5 and 6

Dar'Khan's apprentice and the heart of the final mission. He should not fight.



Ilthanar

Medium Humanoid (Elf), Neutral Good

AC 10
Initiative +0 (10)
HP 9 (2d8)
Speed 30 ft.

		MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE			MOD	SAVE
STR	8	−1	−1	**DEX**	11	+0	+0	**CON**	10	+0	+0
INT	15	+2	+2	**WIS**	10	+0	+0	**CHA**	9	−1	−1

Skills Arcana +4, History +4
Senses Darkvision 60 ft.; Passive Perception 10
Languages Common, Thalassian, Ancient Elvish
CR 1/8 (XP 25; PB +2)

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Advantage on saving throws to avoid or end the Charmed condition; magic can't put this creature to sleep.

The Witness. In Episode 6, if Ilthanar drops to 0 Hit Points, he is automatically stabilized. While he lives, the convoy carries the truth with it.

Actions

Dagger. *Melee Attack Roll:* +2, reach 5 ft. *Hit:* 2 (1d4) Piercing damage.

Spellcasting. Ilthanar casts one of the following spells, using Intelligence as the spellcasting ability (spell save DC 12):

At Will: Light, Prestidigitation *1/Day:* Sleep

Appendix B: Magic Items

> *"It wasn't for shooting, but for remembering."*
> — Sylvanas Windrunner

The items the characters can receive or seize during the adventure, with the moment they are obtained. The last two belong to Sylvanas and Arthas and are beyond the group's reach: they are included for reference.

Windrunner Arrow

Wondrous Item, Uncommon

Where it is obtained: Episode 4: Sylvanas gives it on the night of victory.

A shaft of white wood and blue fletching with the Windrunner eagle. Lireesa gave one to each daughter after her first victory. It is not made to be shot, but to remember.

Remembrance. While you carry it, if you fail a saving throw to avoid or end the Frightened condition, you can reroll it and must use the new roll. You can't use this property again until the next dawn.

The Last Vision. In Episode 6, whoever holds the arrow witnesses Sylvanas's transformation even if they are not on the crag.

The Last Shot. The arrow can be shot from any bow. The attack roll hits automatically and deals an extra 4d6 Radiant damage. Afterward, the arrow crumbles into white ash and loses all its properties, the remembrance included.

Cloak of the Silvermoon Rangers

Wondrous Item, Uncommon (Requires Attunement)

Where it is obtained: Episode 3: Halduron gives it to whoever rescues Taeren on the bridge.

Moss-colored wool, with the rangers' leaf brooch.

Hood of the Thicket. While you wear the hood up, you have advantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks and can take the Hide action even if you are only lightly obscured by foliage.

Ranger's Stride. Natural Difficult Terrain doesn't reduce your Speed.

Collapse Rune

Wondrous Item, Uncommon (Consumable)

Where it is obtained: Episode 3: Aelyra hands over 1d2 spare runes after the bridge falls.

A plate of white stone engraved with a ranger rune.

As a Magic action, you can fix the rune to a structure or immobile object within your reach. With another Magic action and a successful DC 13 Intelligence (Arcana) check, you activate it: the structure takes 50 Force damage. *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 14, each creature in a 10-foot Cube centered on the rune. *Failure:* 14 (4d6) Bludgeoning damage and the Prone condition. *Success:* Half damage. The rune is consumed.

Vial of the Sunwell

Potion, Rare

Where it is obtained: Episode 5: Seraphel gives it in thanks for keeping her secret.

Water drawn from the Sunwell before Arthas poisoned it. It will be the last there is.

When you drink it, you regain 4d4 + 4 Hit Points and end any effect that has you Charmed or cursed. For 1 hour you have resistance to Necrotic damage.

If it is saved until the epilogue, the GM can turn it into the last memory of a kingdom that no longer exists.



Ash Talisman

Wondrous Item, Rare (Requires Attunement by a Spellcaster)

Where it is obtained: Episode 4, if they capture Ul'gruk; or Episode 6.

A pendant of blackened bone that breathes out a thin, sulfur-smelling smoke.

Gust of Ash. *Trigger:* A creature you can see within 30 feet succeeds on an ability check or an attack roll. *Response:* Using your reaction, you force it to reroll and use the lower result. This property recharges at dawn.

Call the Felsteed. As a Magic action, you summon a felsteed (see Appendix A) that obeys you for 1 hour. This property recharges at dawn.

Fel Curse. While you are attuned, the talisman whispers in the tongue of demons. Each time you use one of its properties, you must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or gain 1 Exhaustion level. You can't end the attunement voluntarily: it takes the *Remove Curse* spell.

Seal of Dar'Khan

Wondrous Item, Uncommon

Where it is obtained: Episode 5: Ilthanar tears it from his master's desk.

A silver seal bearing the magister's arms. It is the proof of the treason.

Irrefutable Proof. While you display it, you have advantage on Charisma checks to convince the mages of the Kirin Tor or the authorities of Quel'Thalas of Dar'Khan's treason.

Rune Key. While you hold it, you have advantage on Intelligence (Arcana) checks to examine, understand or alter the runes traced by Dar'Khan.

Magister's Ring

Ring, Rare (Requires Attunement by a Wizard or Sorcerer)

Where it is obtained: Episode 5: when Dar'Khan sinks into the basin, one of his rings is left on the rim.

Scarlet gold with a gem that hums faintly. Inside it, a sickly green is beginning to spread.

The ring has 3 charges and regains 1d3 at dawn.

Rune Shield. You can expend 1 charge to cast *Shield*.

Counter-Rune. You can expend 2 charges to cast *Counterspell*.

Corruption. When you expend the last charge, roll 1d20. On a 1, the ring blackens and loses its magic forever.

White Bow of the Windrunners

Weapon (Longbow), Legendary (Requires Attunement)

Where it is obtained: Not available: Sylvanas carries it to the end.

A longbow of white wood carved with the eagle of her house.

You have a +2 bonus to attack rolls and damage rolls made with this magic weapon, which deals an extra 2d6 Radiant damage on a hit. Your attacks with it don't have disadvantage at long range.

Volley. As a Magic action, you loose a rain of arrows over a 20-foot-radius, 30-foot-high Cylinder centered on a point you can see within 150 feet. *Dexterity Saving Throw:* DC 17, each creature of your choice in the Cylinder. *Failure:* 31 (7d8) Piercing damage. *Success:* Half damage. This property recharges at dawn.

Frostmourne

Weapon (Greatsword), Artifact (Requires Attunement by an Evil Creature)

Where it is obtained: The sword of Arthas. For reference only.

A runeblade that breathes frost. The Lich King speaks through it.

You have a +3 bonus to attack rolls and damage rolls made with this magic weapon, which deals an extra 4d8 Cold damage on a hit.

Devourer of Souls. A creature reduced to 0 Hit Points by this weapon dies instantly. Its soul is trapped in the blade and can't be returned to life by any means short of a *Wish*.

Voice of the Lich King. The wielder hears the voice of the Lich King and is permanently Charmed by him; no means can end this condition while the wielder remains attuned to the sword.

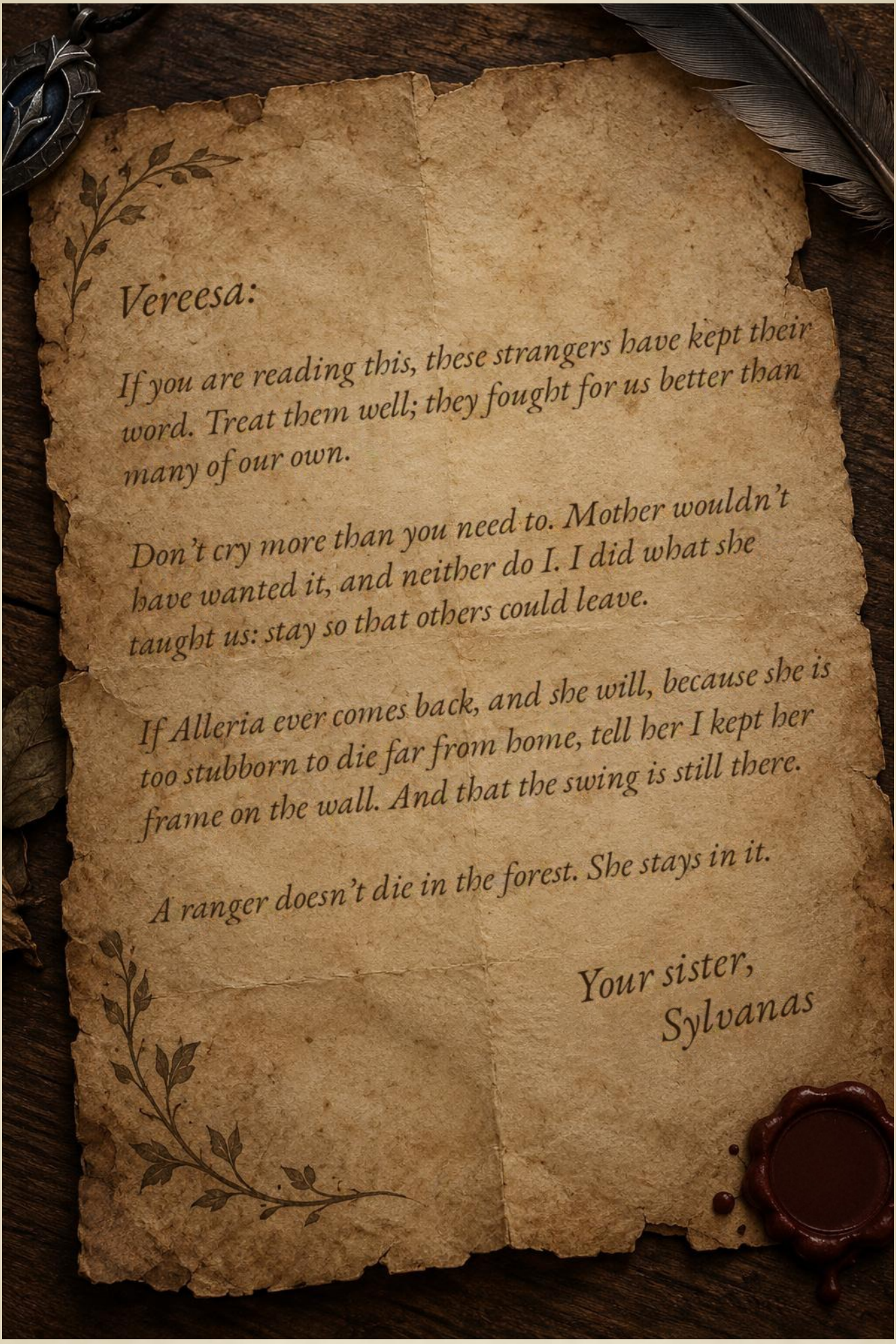
Destruction. No one knows how to destroy it. For many years, no one will manage it.



Appendix C: To Be Adjusted to the Sourcebook

The adventure was written before the publication of the setting's sourcebook. When it is available, the following points should be reviewed.

- ☐ Challenge ratings and statistics of ghouls, skeletons, abominations, crypt fiends, gargoyles, felhounds and cultists.
- ☐ Provisional stat blocks in Appendix A, especially those of Ul'gruk and Dar'Khan.
- ☐ Rarity and properties of the items in Appendix B.
- ☐ Final difficulty classes for the pursuit (Episode 4) and the felsteed's stat block.
- ☐ The chapel's canonical name before the battle that renamed it, if there is one.
- ☐ The moment when Lor'themar loses his eye.
- ☐ Windrunner family details (the deaths of Lireesa and Lirath).


Vereesa:
If you are reading this, these strangers have kept their word. Treat them well; they fought for us better than many of our own.
Don't cry more than you need to. Mother wouldn't have wanted it, and neither do I. I did what she taught us: stay so that others could leave.
If Alleria ever comes back, and she will, because she is too stubborn to die far from home, tell her I kept her frame on the wall. And that the swing is still there.
A ranger doesn't die in the forest. She stays in it.
Your sister,
Sylvanas